Abdullah Al Zahid

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SUMMARY

Transportation engineer with a master's degree who has simulated how Ontario Line construction staging and road closures affect surrounding streets, assessed what construction restrictions do to GO rail service, and reviews transportation studies for the City of Toronto.

EXPERIENCE

Assistant Planner, Transportation Planning

City of Toronto | January 2024 – present

- Review development applications and the transportation studies filed with them against City standards and Official Plan policy, and recommend conditions where something is missing.
- Coordinate with divisions, consultants, applicants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict, and work issues through to a position everyone can act on.
- Build and maintain the road and right-of-way datasets the division depends on, using GIS and Python, including a ROW-width dataset covering all city roads, built with QGIS, MapBox and JavaScript.
- Run assigned studies from scoping through to recommendations, writing the briefing notes that come out of them and presenting to planners, engineers and managers in other divisions.

Transportation Planner, Simulation and Modelling

Metrolinx, Service Design | February 2023 – January 2024

- Ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services to establish what proposed operating and infrastructure changes would do to run times, reliability and recovery before they were taken forward.
- Assessed the service effect of temporary and permanent slow orders, the kind of restriction that construction on an operating railway imposes.
- Built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and produced summaries of speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.
- Set up a command line workflow so temporary and permanent slow orders could be pre-simulated in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours.

Graduate Transportation Planner

Mott MacDonald | January – February 2023

- Short consulting placement on Ontario Line work. Ran traffic simulations to estimate how construction staging would affect surrounding streets, and prepared the supporting material for the project team.

Graduate Research Assistant

University of Alberta | January 2020 – August 2022

- Master's research on how road networks perform during emergency evacuations, using macroscopic (LWR) and agent-based (MATSim) models.
- Worked with large travel datasets and wrote up results for readers without a modelling background.

SKILLS

Traffic simulation of construction staging and road closures (Synchro); VISSIM. Review of transportation studies and submissions against City standards. Coordination with City divisions, agencies and consultants. AutoCAD and Civil 3D. ArcGIS Pro and QGIS. Python and SQL. Reports and presentations.

EDUCATION

MSc, Transportation Engineering — University of Alberta, 2022

BSc, Civil Engineering — Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology, 2018

BSc, Computer Science — University of British Columbia, in progress (2025–2027)